

Benzyl Alcohol



What is it?

Benzyl alcohol is a naturally-occurring substance which may be used as a fragrance, solvent or preservative. It smells mildly sweet. It is one of the components of Balsam of Peru and is found at high concentrations in the essential oils of jasmine, hyacinth, and ylang-ylang. **It may be found in products labelled “fragrance free.”**

Products with the terms *natural*, *unscented*, *hypoallergenic*, and *fragrance free* are not regulated and thus may contain fragrance. Do not trust these labels. However, know that true *fragrance-free* products do exist.

BENZYL ALCOHOL is also known as:

- Phenylcarbinol
- Phenylmethanol, phenylmethyl alcohol
- Benzene methanol
- Benzylic alcohol
- a-hydroxytoluene
- Benzoyl alcohol
- Benzenecarbinol

Some Possible Uses of BENZYL ALCOHOL / Where it might be found:

Personal Care Products

- Liquid and bar soap, cleansers
- Cream, lotion, oil
- Bath oil, gel
- Shaving lotion, after shave
- Shaving cream, gel, hair removal cream
- Perfume, cologne, body mist
- Make-up, make-up remover, toner
- Lip balms
- Deodorant, anti-perspirant

- Anti-aging cream
- Sunscreen, sunless tanner
- Analgesic rub
- Ointment (i.e. diaper or medicated)
- Hygiene spray, rinse
- Baby wipes, moist wipes
- Shampoo, conditioner
- Hair tonic, oil, gel, mousse, spray
- Toothpaste, mouth wash, dental items
- Oils (i.e. massage, essential, consecrate)

In the air

- Candles and incense
- Diffused essential oils, aromatherapy

Medical Items

- Surgical scrub
- Wound and burn care, anti-septics
- Medicated cream, spray
- Tincture of benzoin
- Preservative in injectable medicines

Household Items

- Dish soap
- Laundry detergent
- Fabric softener, dryer sheet
- Cleaner, anti-odor sprays
- E cigarettes, scented or flavored tobacco
- Air vent systems (i.e. hotels, casinos)

Other sources of BENZYL ALCOHOL exposure:

Some topical medicated products may contain benzyl alcohol. Some examples include:

- Amcinonide
- Benzoyl peroxide
- Betamethasone dipropionate
- Ciclopirox

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- Clotrimazole
- Delgocitinib
- Diclofenac sodium
- Doxepin
- Fluorouracil
- Flurandrenolide
- Hydrocortisone
- Hydroquinone
- Imiquimod
- Metronidazole
- Mupirocin
- Naftifine
- Pimecrolimus
- Sodium sulfacetamide
- Tazarotene
- Tretinoin
- Triamcinolone
- Eye products

Benzyl alcohol may also be found in injectable medications, such as:

- Allergy shots
- Botox
- Gallium
- Heparin
- Hormones
- Local anesthetics
- Saline solution
- Steroids (i.e. dexamethasone)
- Tranquilizers (i.e. haloperidol)
- Vitamin B12
- Some vaccines

Other products that might react like BENZYL ALCOHOL:

- Other fragrances
- Benzyl salicylate
- Hydroxybenzyl alcohol

- Methylbenzyl alcohol
- Benzoic acid
- Sodium benzoate

What should I do to avoid BENZYL ALCOHOL?

It is best to avoid all fragrance. Even if marketed as *unscented* or *fragrance-free*, these products can contain fragrance. Look for fragrance, plant, or botanical names on labels. For products at home with no ingredients, go to the store to inspect the original package or look at the manufacturer's or store's website.

You may have to avoid airborne fragrance. For example, candles and incense. Exposure may also occur from contact with partners that use fragrance.

To identify workplace exposure, check ingredient lists. Sometimes fragrance is present even though not listed. You may need to contact the manufacturer. Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS) sheets usually do not include the full ingredient list. Substitute fragrance-free alternatives or wear rubber or vinyl gloves.

Your exposure to fragrance may be from contact with a partner who uses an item with fragrance.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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